

began, and which God alone knows
when, & how it will end -

The above was a part of a letter
written by M. E. Stone, R. M. to a friend the

morning after the news reached here
of the reception of the Mass troops
in the city of Baltimore the 19th
of April 1861 -

Rates.		Unpaid.		By Stamps.		In Money.		Free.	
Cents.	No.	Dolls.	Cents.	No.	Dolls.	Cents.	No.	Cents.	No.

PAID HERE

To

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LETTERS from North Oxford, Mass.

them safely at Head quarters. - I have no doubt -
but it has all been properly done, - A boy for the
25th I had delivered to Capt. Atwood's co -
and heard with much satisfaction the gratification
it afforded the anxious recipients. - The men
was looking splendidly, and I need not tell
you that ^{the 25th} is a "live" regiment from its Cal
& Chaplain down. Worcester to his just cause
for pride.

I come now to the expression in your
excellent letter which I feel all along
feared - one our labors needed, shall we not
a shall we "furnish" - for the fact I have
dreaded lest a sense of women's uncertainties in regard
to matters here should discourage the efforts of our
patriotic ^{ladies} ~~ladies~~ at home - it was this
fear and only this which can give me courage
to ^{arrange} ~~address~~ the worthy ladies of our committee
(so worthy my superior) ^{to confer} ~~in my~~ ^{small} ~~in my~~ ^{in my}
affairs which they seem perfectly familiar
knowing so little. - ~~And~~ ^{And} now I see
how hard to reply - It is said that our Army
is supplied - All this may be so it is not for me
to gainsay - and so far as ^{the} New England troops are
concerned ^{it} may be that in these days of idleness
they have really no pressing wants - But in the

Apr 19/1861